

Searching for Scalar Dark Matter with Compact Mechanical Resonators

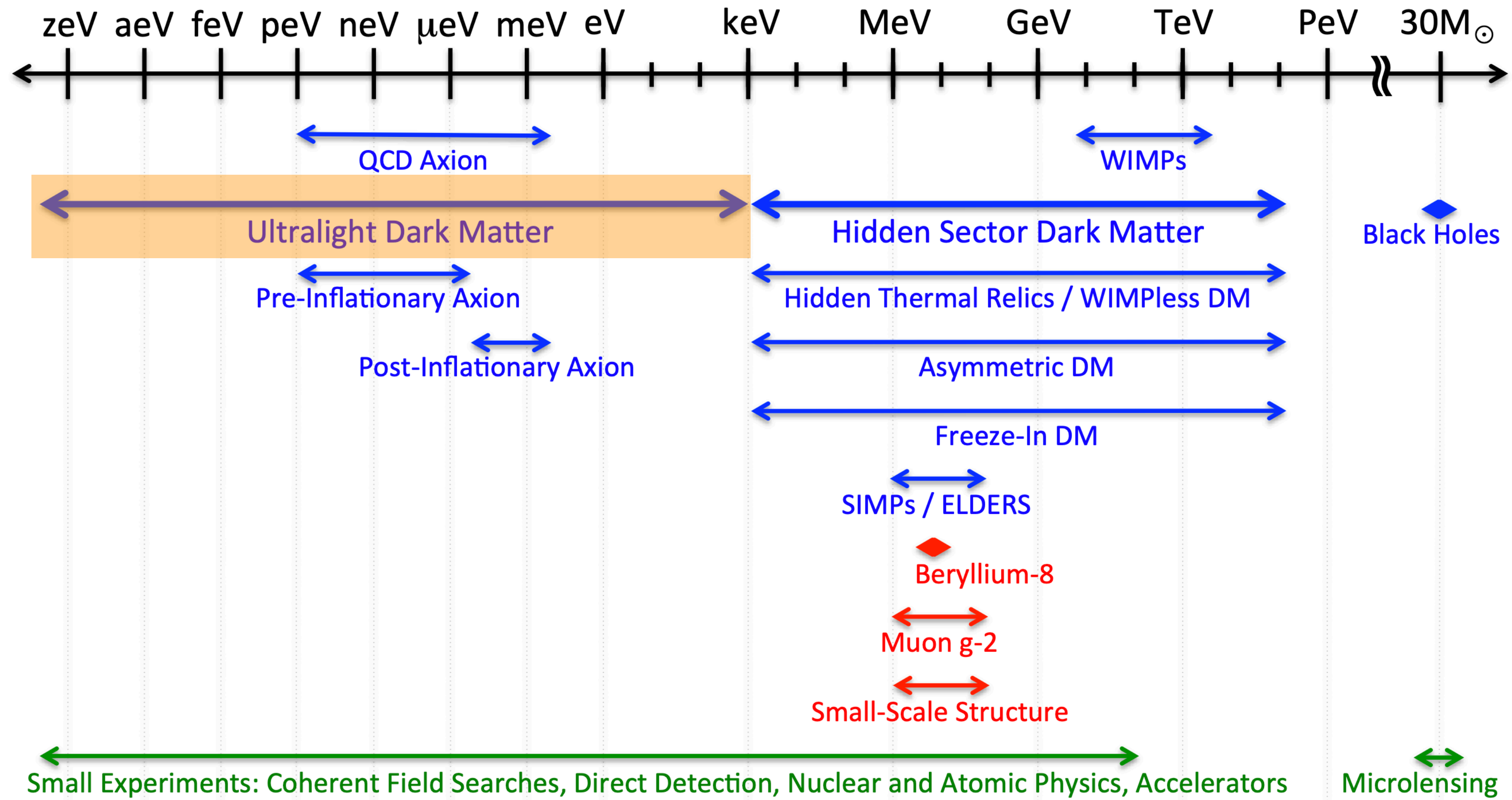
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Qualifying Exam
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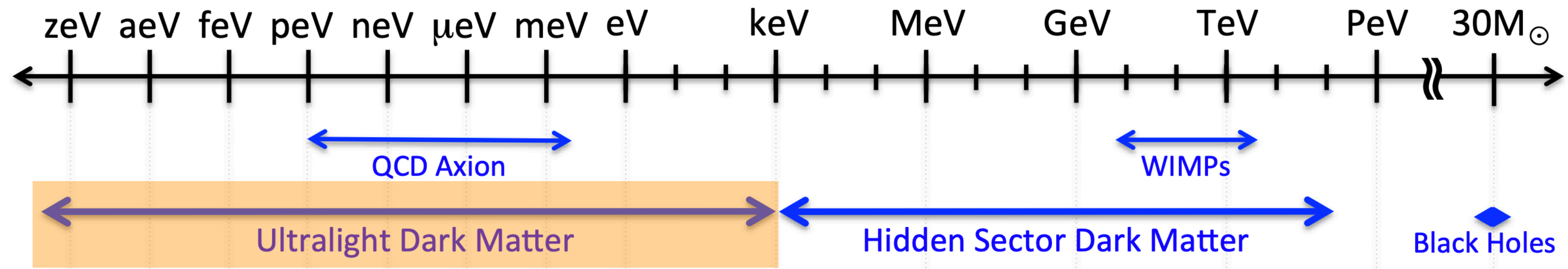
Outline

- Dilaton Dark Matter
- Mechanical Resonators
- Optomechanical Setup

Motivation: Dark Matter



Motivation: Dark Matter



- We essentially only know:
 - Locally $\rho_{\text{DM}} \sim 0.4 \text{ GeV}/\text{cm}^3$ and $v_{\text{DM}} \sim 10^{-3}c$
 - Interacts weakly with Standard Model
 - Mostly cold, and stable enough to still exist today

Motivation: Effective Field Theory

- Parametrize action at high scales as $S_\Lambda = \int d^4x \sum_i \Lambda^{4-d_i} g_i(\Lambda) \mathcal{O}_i$
- General expectation as Λ decreases:
 - Initial couplings for $d_i > 4$ shrink, $d_i < 4$ grow
 - Couplings generate each other unless forbidden by symmetries
- At low scales: **lowest dimensional operators dominate**, mostly independent of UV, and easiest to search for

Leading Couplings for Ultralight Bosons

UV motivation?

Scalar ϕ $\mathcal{L} \supset \phi F^{\mu\nu} F_{\mu\nu} + \phi G^{\mu\nu} G_{\mu\nu} + \phi \bar{\psi} \psi$

Pseudoscalar a $\mathcal{L} \supset a F^{\mu\nu} \tilde{F}_{\mu\nu} + a G^{\mu\nu} \tilde{G}_{\mu\nu} + a \bar{\psi} \gamma^5 \psi$

Vector A'_μ $\mathcal{L} \supset A'_\mu \bar{\psi} \gamma^\mu \psi + F'_{\mu\nu} F^{\mu\nu}$

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Pseudoscalar a

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Vector A'_μ

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Leading Couplings for Ultralight Bosons

UV motivation

Scalar ϕ	$\mathcal{L} \supset \phi F^{\mu\nu} F_{\mu\nu} + \phi G^{\mu\nu} G_{\mu\nu} + \phi \bar{\psi} \psi$	Higgs portal/relaxion $\phi h^\dagger h$
Pseudoscalar a	$\mathcal{L} \supset a F^{\mu\nu} \tilde{F}_{\mu\nu} + a G^{\mu\nu} \tilde{G}_{\mu\nu} + a \bar{\psi} \gamma^5 \psi$	QCD axion $m_a \sim \Lambda_{\text{QCD}}^2 / f_a$
Vector A'_μ	$\mathcal{L} \supset A'_\mu \bar{\psi} \gamma^\mu \psi + F'_{\mu\nu} F^{\mu\nu}$	Dark $U(1)$ or $U(1)_{B-L}$

Leading Couplings for Ultralight Bosons

Mass protection

Scalar ϕ

$$\mathcal{L} \supset \phi F^{\mu\nu} F_{\mu\nu} + \phi G^{\mu\nu} G_{\mu\nu} + \phi \bar{\psi} \psi$$

Can't by symmetry

Pseudoscalar a

$$\mathcal{L} \supset a F^{\mu\nu} \tilde{F}_{\mu\nu} + a G^{\mu\nu} \tilde{G}_{\mu\nu} + a \bar{\psi} \gamma^5 \psi$$

Shift symmetry

Vector A'_μ

$$\mathcal{L} \supset A'_\mu \bar{\psi} \gamma^\mu \psi + F'_{\mu\nu} F^{\mu\nu}$$

Gauge symmetry

Couplings for Light Dilaton

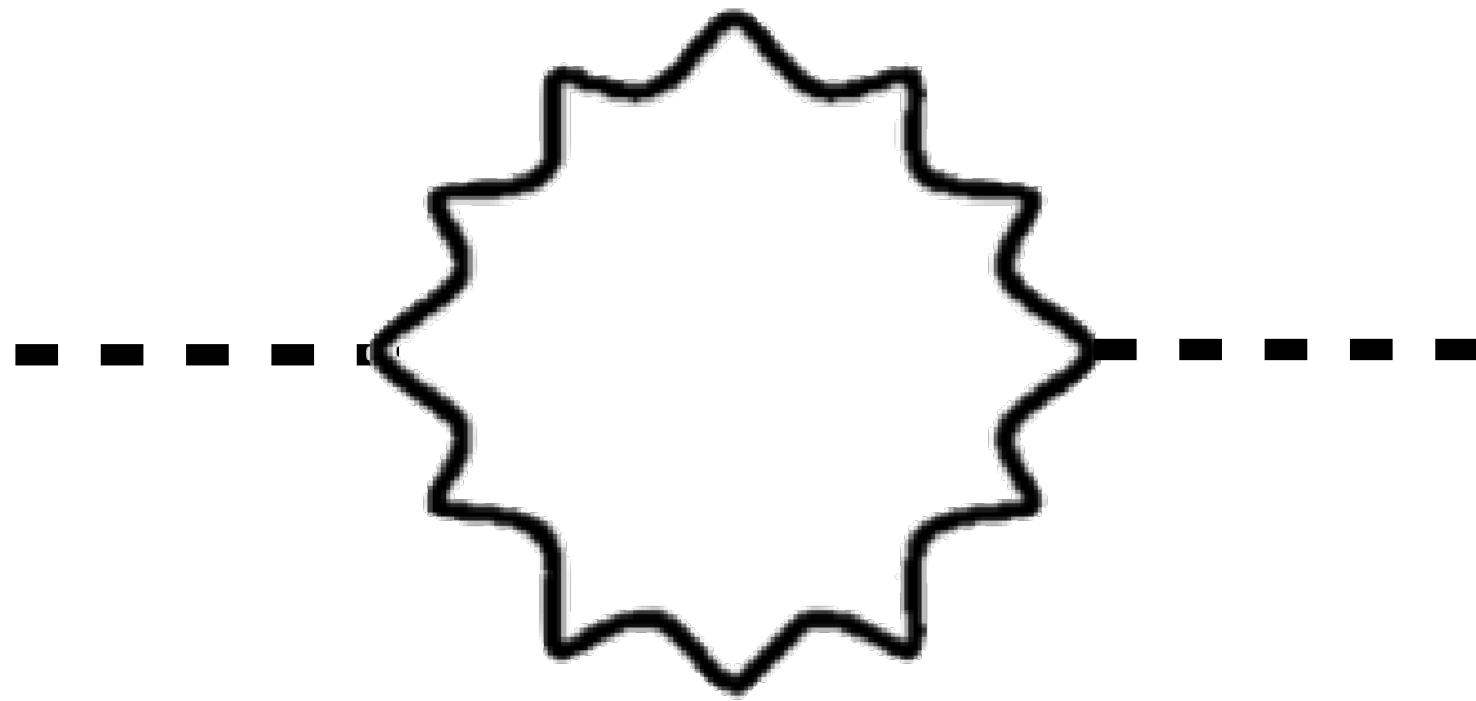
$$\mathcal{L} \supset \frac{1}{2}(\partial_\mu \phi)^2 - \frac{1}{2}m^2\phi^2 + \frac{\phi}{M_{\text{pl}}} \left(\frac{d_e}{4} F_{\mu\nu} F^{\mu\nu} - d_{m_e} m_e \bar{e} e \right)$$

d_i give coupling strength relative to gravity

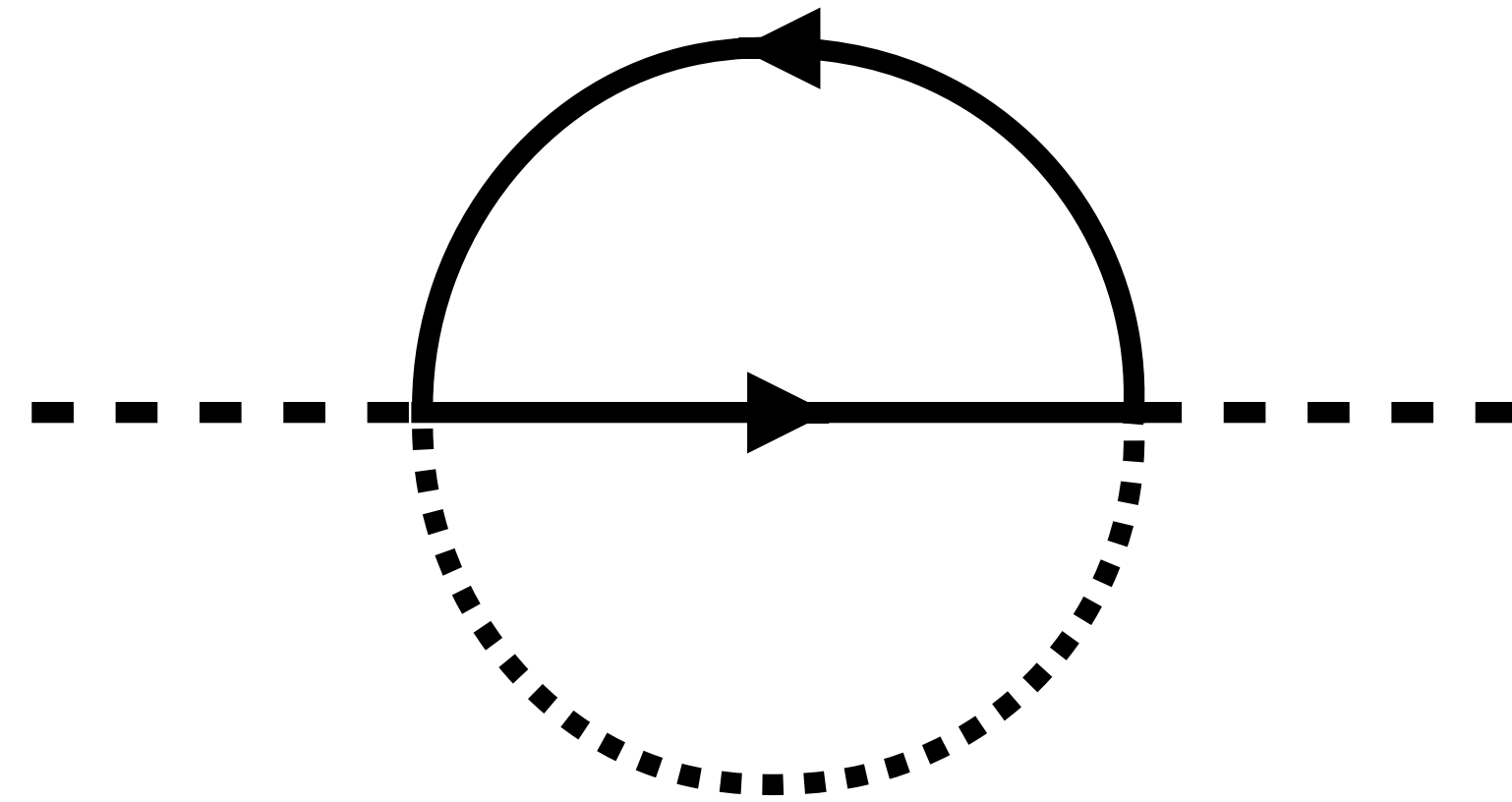
Focus on linear couplings

Mass Corrections

$$\mathcal{L} \supset \frac{1}{2}(\partial_\mu \phi)^2 - \frac{1}{2}m^2 \phi^2 + \frac{\phi}{M_{\text{pl}}} \left(\frac{d_e}{4} B_{\mu\nu} B^{\mu\nu} - d_{m_e} y_e \bar{L} h E \right)$$



$$\delta m^2 = \frac{d_e^2}{2} \frac{1}{(4\pi)^2} \frac{\Lambda^4}{M_{\text{pl}}^2}$$



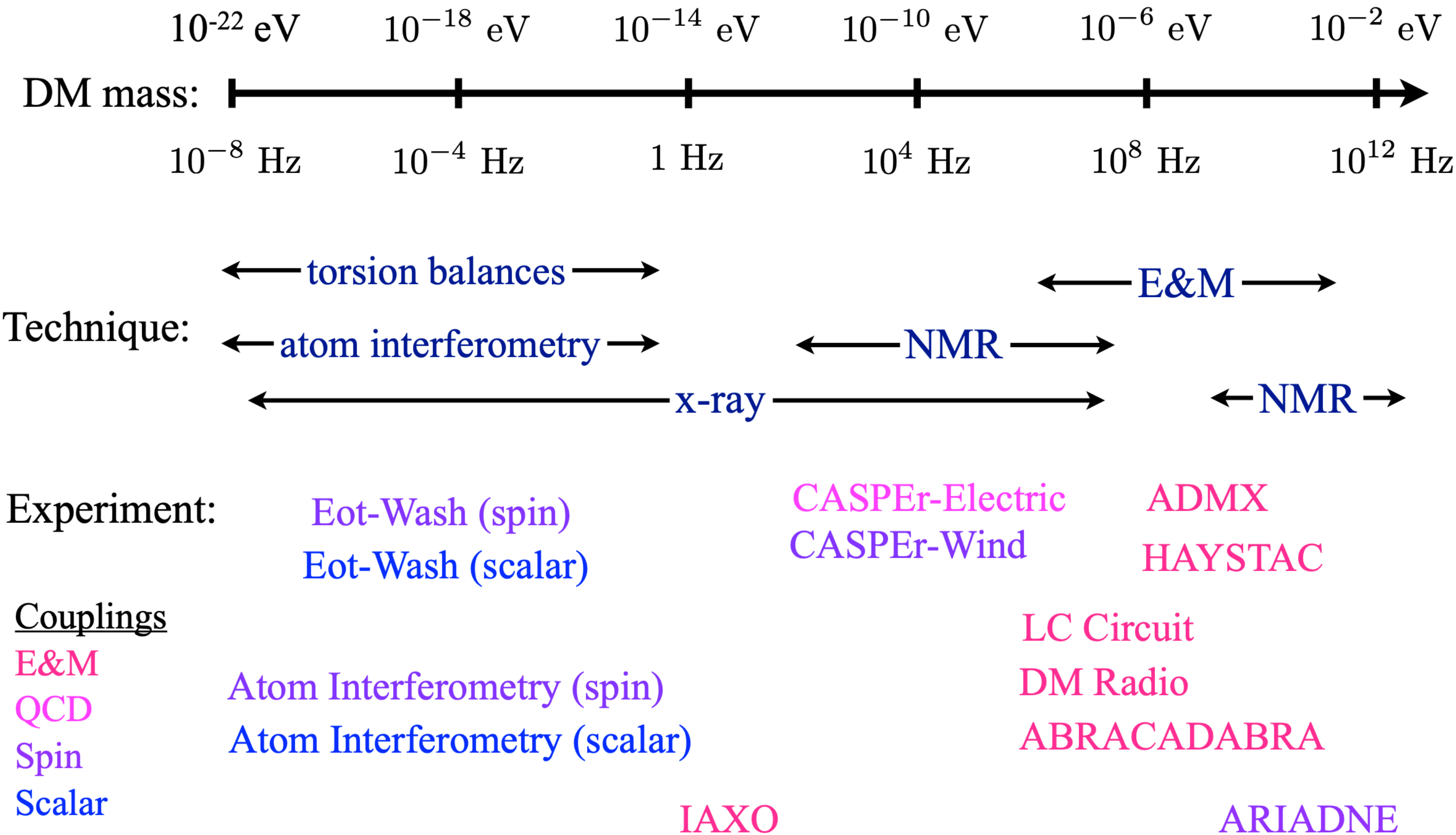
$$\delta m^2 = \frac{d_{m_e}^2 y_e^2}{2} \frac{1}{(4\pi)^4} \frac{\Lambda^4}{M_{\text{pl}}^2}$$

For $m \sim 10^{-10}$ eV and $\Lambda = 10$ TeV, okay if $d_{m_e} \lesssim 1$

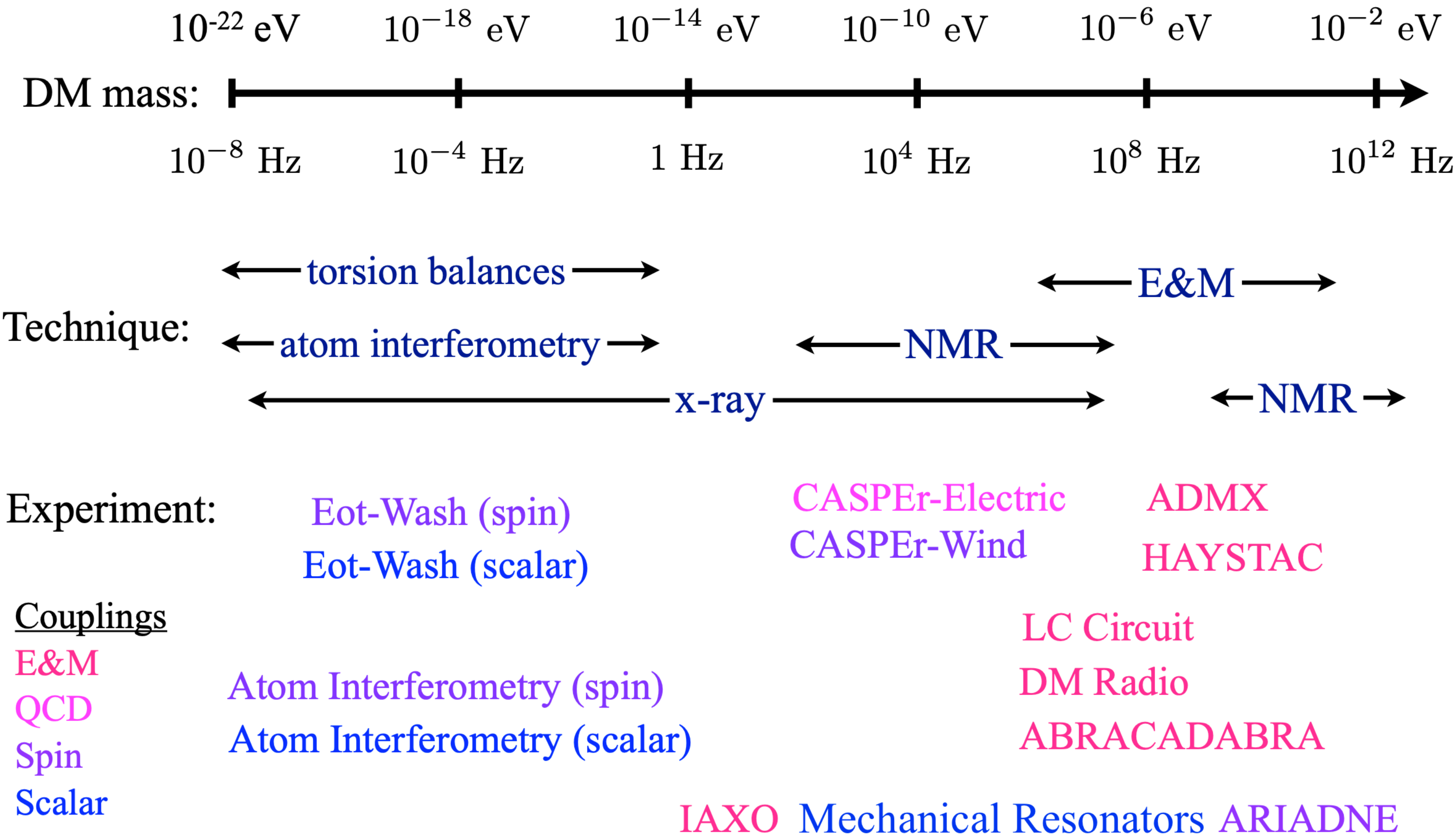
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A Crowded Field



A Crowded Field



Dilaton Effects

$$\mathcal{L} \supset \frac{1}{2}(\partial_\mu \phi)^2 - \frac{1}{2}m^2\phi^2 + \frac{\phi}{M_{\text{pl}}} \left(\frac{d_e}{4} F_{\mu\nu} F^{\mu\nu} - d_{m_e} m_e \bar{e} e \right)$$

$$\frac{\delta\alpha}{\alpha} = \frac{d_e\phi}{M_{\text{pl}}} \quad \frac{\delta m_e}{m_e} = \frac{d_{m_e}\phi}{M_{\text{pl}}} \quad a_0 \propto \frac{1}{\alpha m_e}$$

Dilaton Effects

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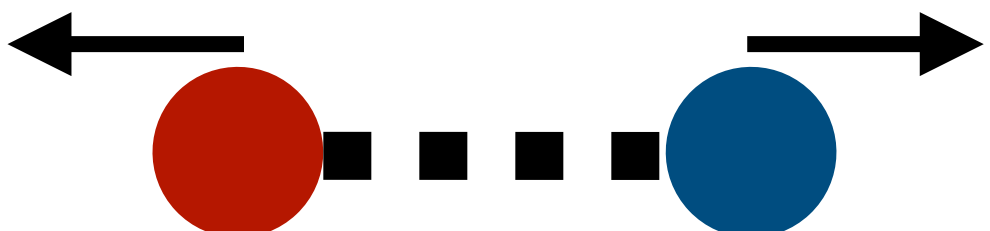
$$\frac{\delta\alpha}{\alpha} = \frac{d_e \phi}{M_{\text{pl}}} \quad \frac{\delta m_e}{m_e} = \frac{d_{m_e} \phi}{M_{\text{pl}}} \quad a_0 \propto \frac{1}{\alpha m_e}$$

$$\text{For dark matter, } \phi(t) \sim \frac{\sqrt{2\rho_{\text{DM}}}}{m} \cos(mt)$$

$$\text{Produces strain } h_{\text{DM}} = (d_{m_e} + d_e) \frac{\sqrt{2\rho_{\text{DM}}}}{M_{\text{pl}} m} \cos(mt) \lesssim 10^{-21}$$

Mechanical Effects

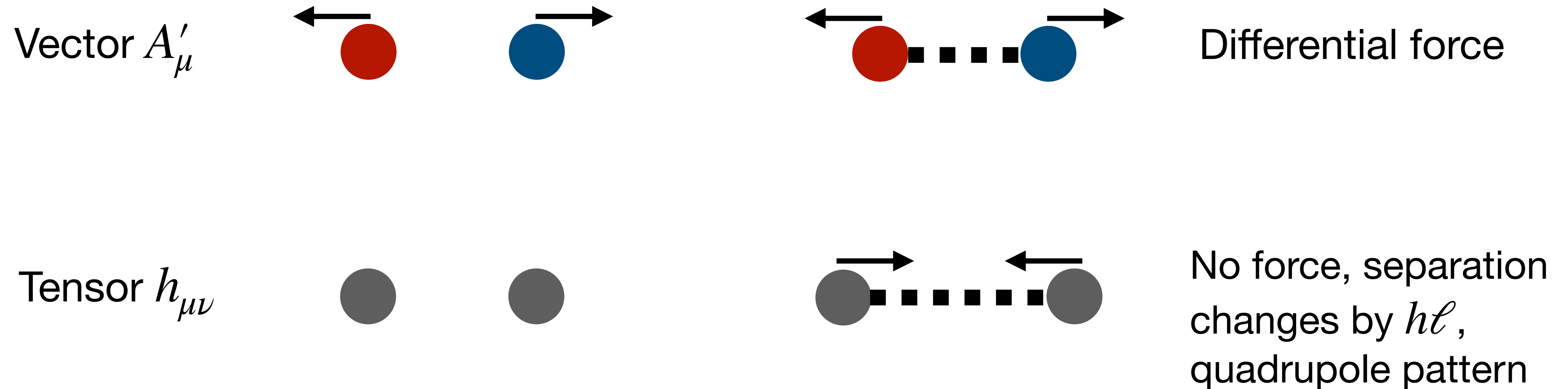
Scalar ϕ

Vector A'_μ   Differential force

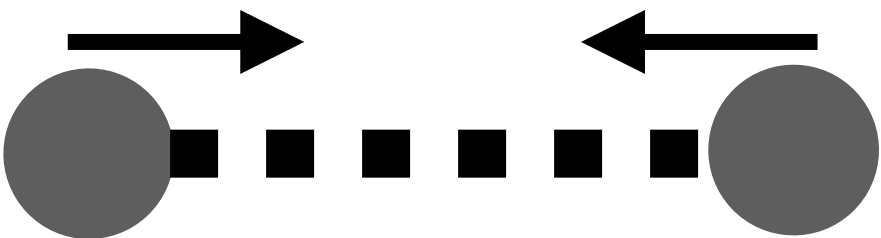
Tensor $h_{\mu\nu}$

Mechanical Effects

Scalar ϕ



Mechanical Effects

Scalar ϕ			No force, rest length changes by $h\ell$, isotropic
Vector A'_μ			Differential force
Tensor $h_{\mu\nu}$			No force, separation changes by $h\ell$, quadrupole pattern

Mechanical Effects

Scalar ϕ



No force, rest length
changes by $h\ell$,
isotropic

Can amplify oscillating field resonantly

Tensor $h_{\mu\nu}$



No force, separation
changes by $h\ell$,
quadrupole pattern

Detecting Strains



Breathing mode displacement q relative to equilibrium:

$$\ddot{q} + \frac{\omega}{Q}\dot{q} + \omega^2 q = \ddot{h}_{\text{DM}}\ell + \frac{f_{\text{th}}}{M}$$

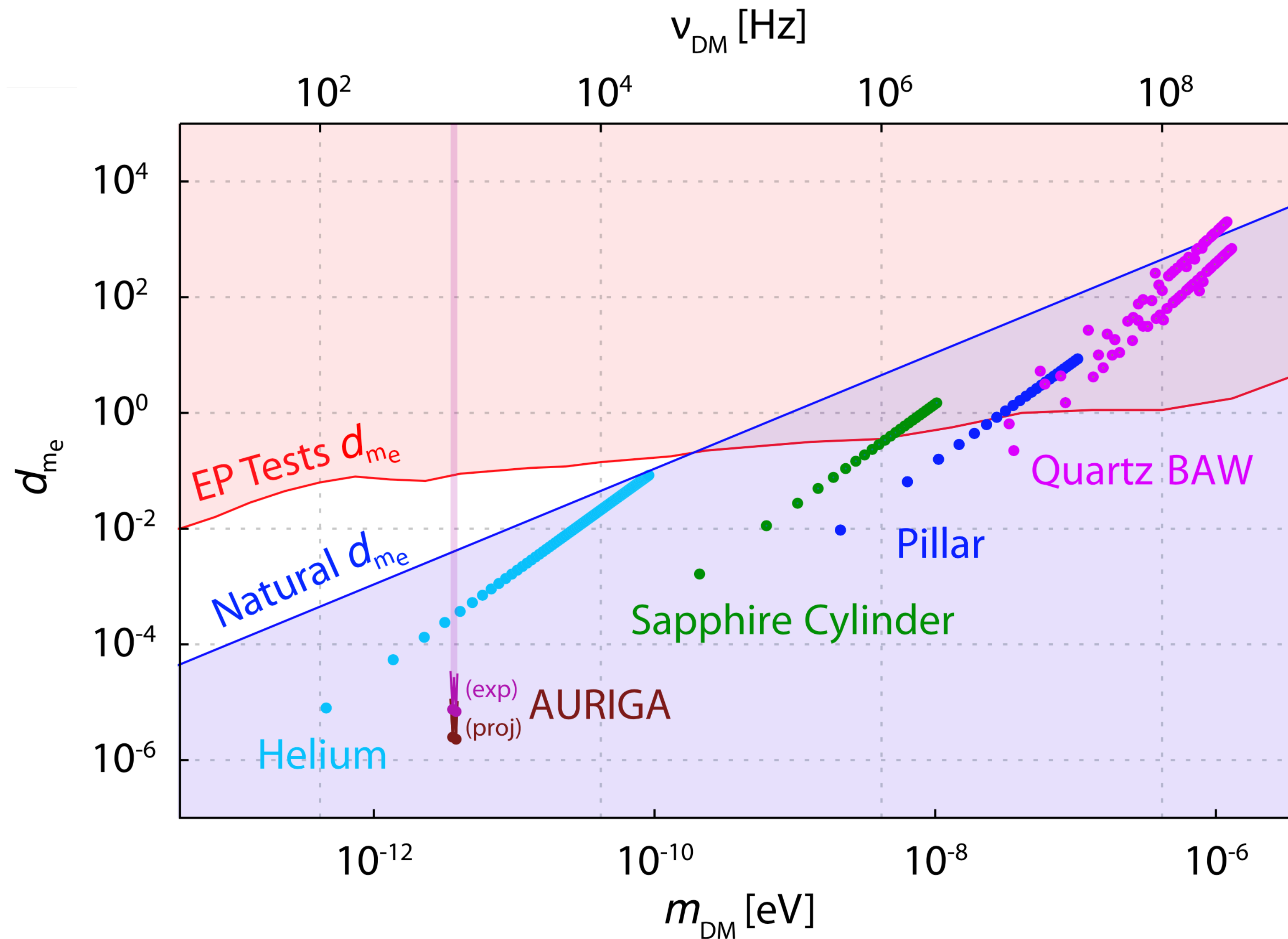
Physical assumptions:

$m \ll \text{eV}$: atoms respond adiabatically

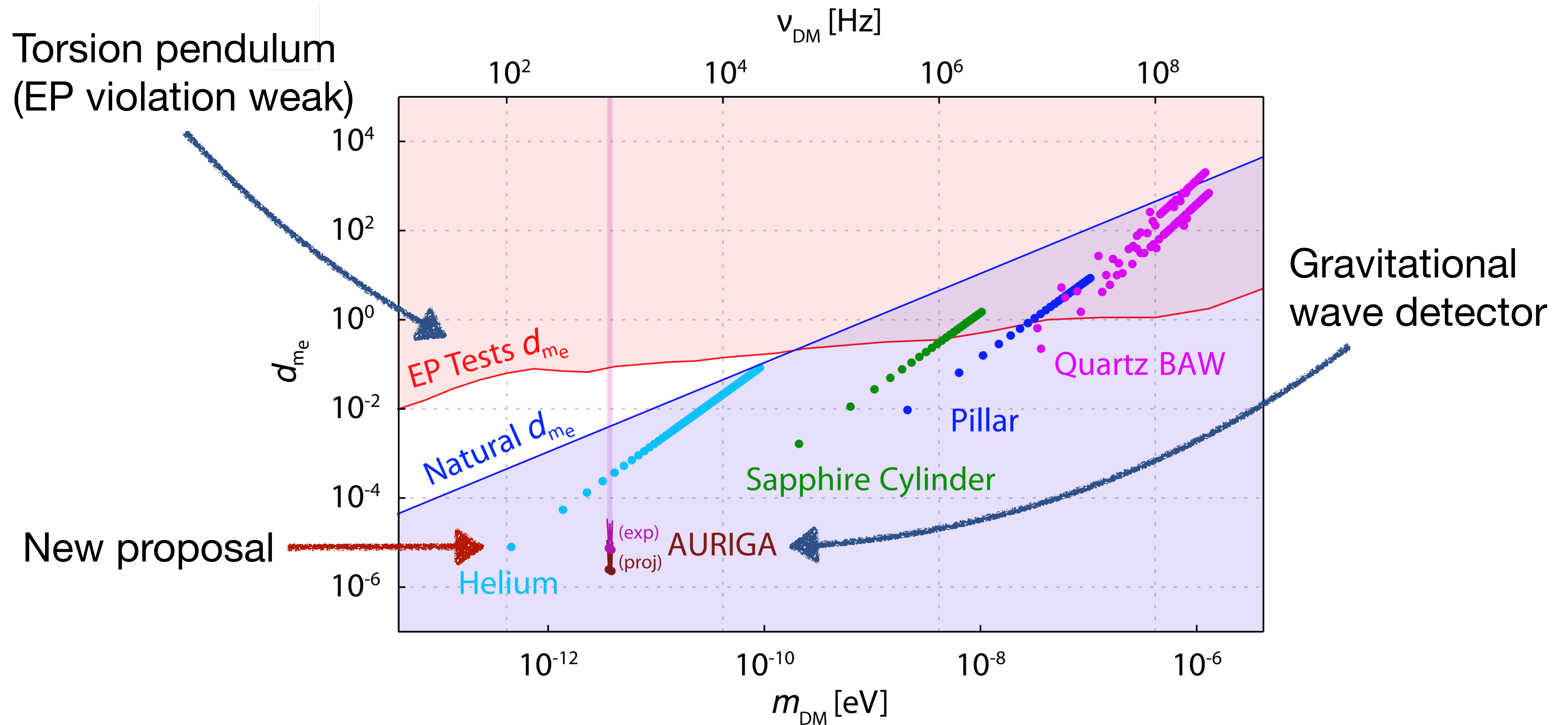
$m \approx \omega$: material responds resonantly

$k = mv \sim \omega/c_s$: constructive effect

Dark Matter Sensitivity



Dark Matter Sensitivity



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Calculating Reach

$$\ddot{q} + \frac{\omega}{Q}\dot{q} + \omega^2 q = \ddot{h}_{\text{DM}}\ell + \frac{f_{\text{th}}}{M}$$

Noise power spectral density:

$$S_{n,hh} \sim \frac{k_B T}{M\ell^2 Q \omega^3} + \text{nonthermal}$$

Signal power spectral density:

$$S_{s,hh} \sim \frac{h_{\text{DM}}^2}{\Delta\omega_{\text{DM}}} \quad \Delta\omega_{\text{DM}} \sim m v_{\text{DM}}^2$$

Signal to noise ratio:

$$\text{SNR}^2 \sim t_{\text{int}} \int d\omega \left(\frac{S_s(\omega)}{S_n(\omega)} \right)^2$$

Calculating Reach

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Signal power spectral density:

$$S_{s,hh} \sim \frac{h_{\text{DM}}^2}{\Delta\omega_{\text{DM}}} \quad \Delta\omega_{\text{DM}} \sim m v_{\text{DM}}^2$$

Signal to noise ratio, thermal noise limited:

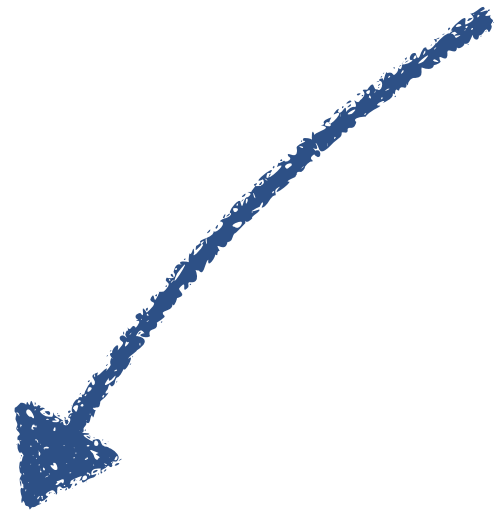
$$\text{SNR}^2 \sim t_{\text{int}} \int d\omega \left(\frac{S_s(\omega)}{S_n(\omega)} \right)^2 \sim t_{\text{int}} \Delta\omega_{\text{DM}} \left(\frac{S_s}{S_n} \right)^2$$

Calculating Reach

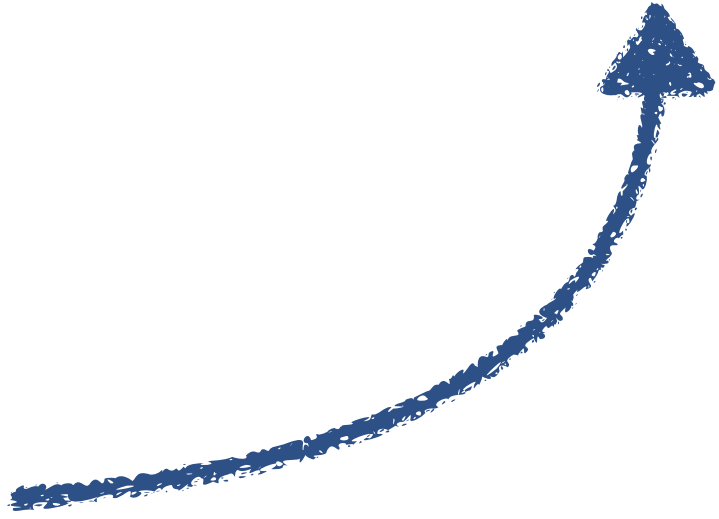
Setting SNR ~ 1 gives:

$$h_{\min}^2 \sim \frac{1}{\sqrt{t_{\text{int}}}} \frac{v_{\text{DM}}}{m^{5/2}} \frac{k_B T}{M \ell^2 Q}$$

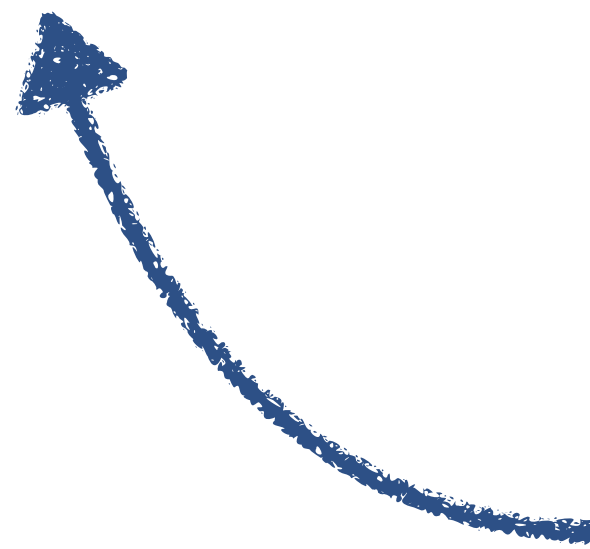
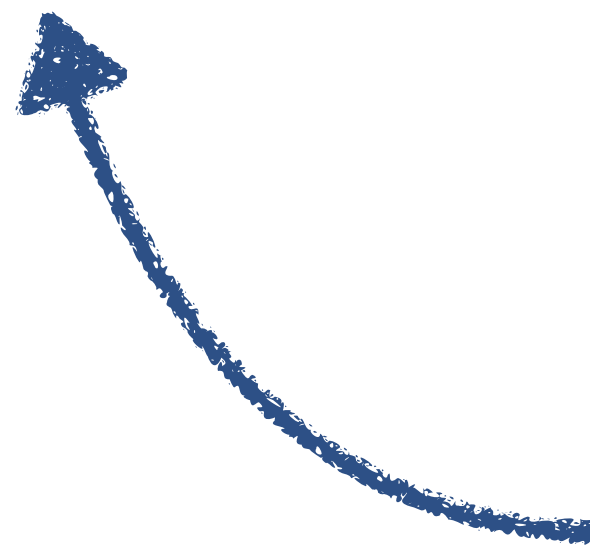
Cool cryogenically



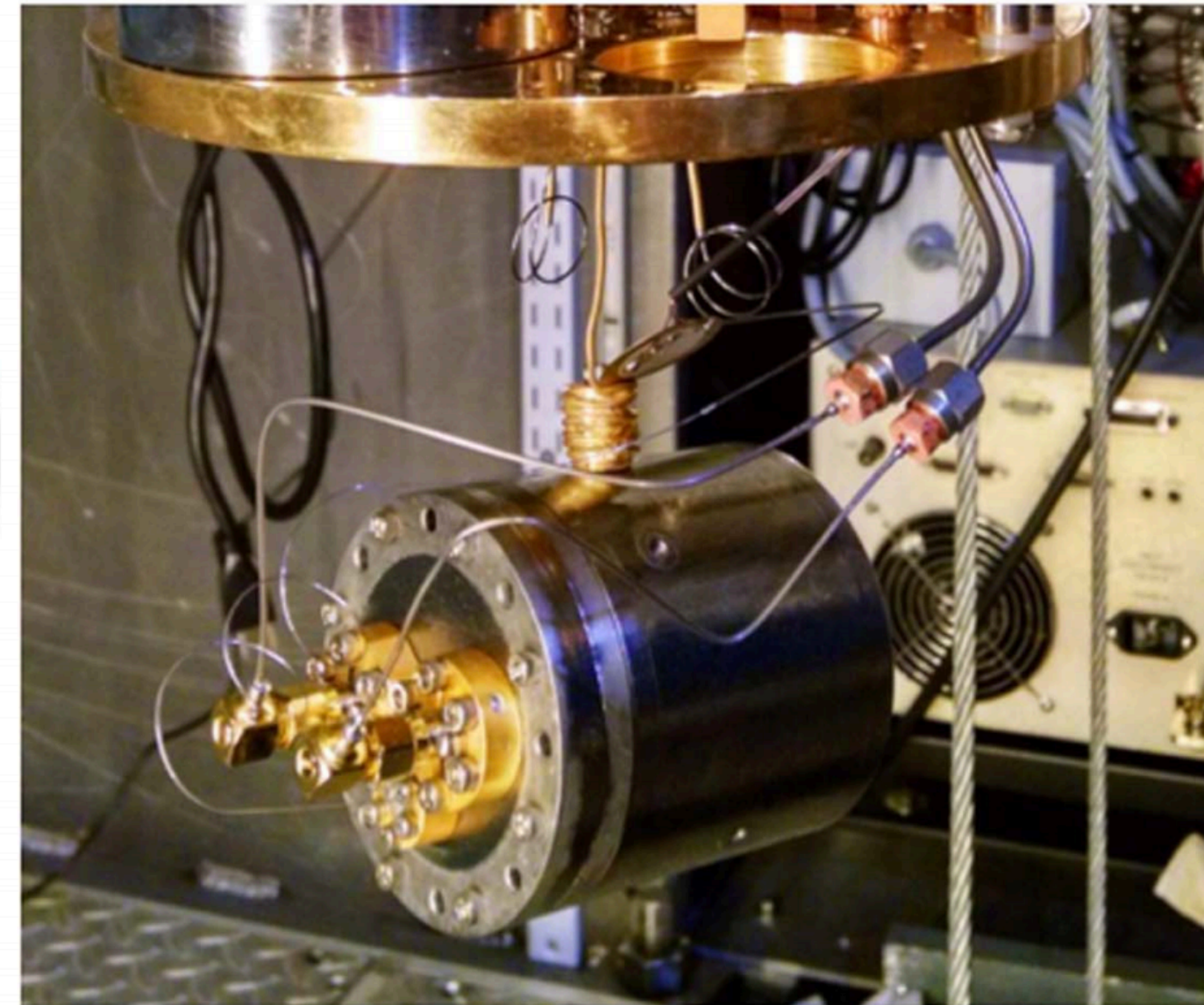
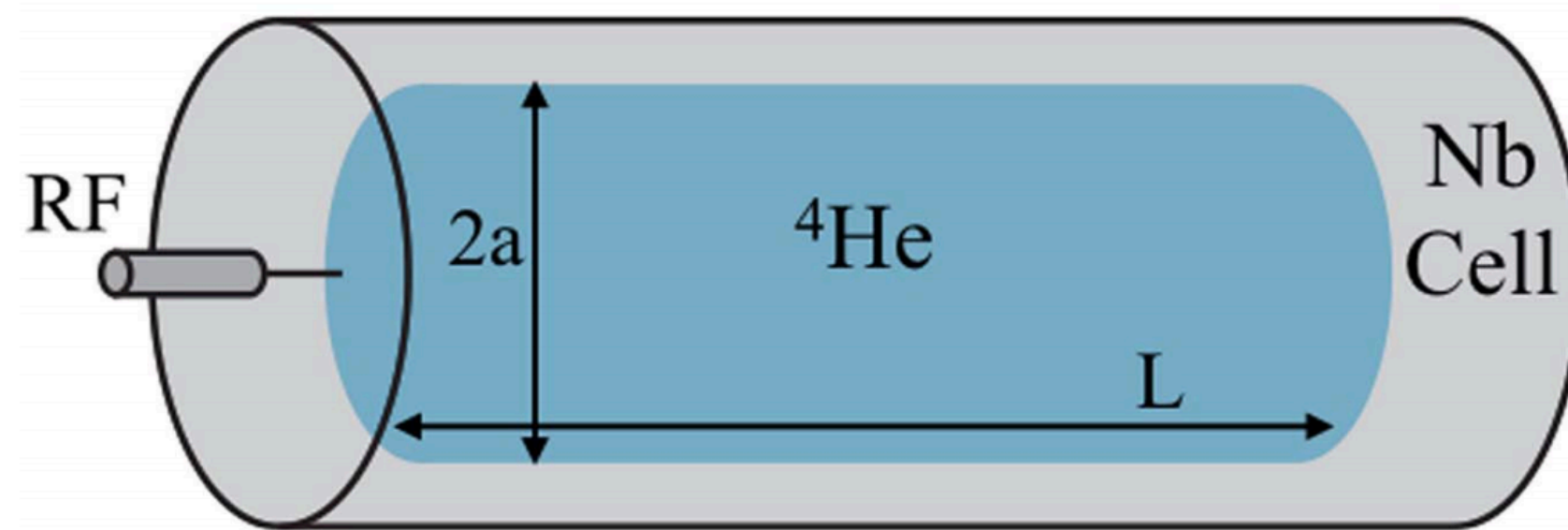
Sets experiment length



Large, heavy, low loss
Higher sound speed helps



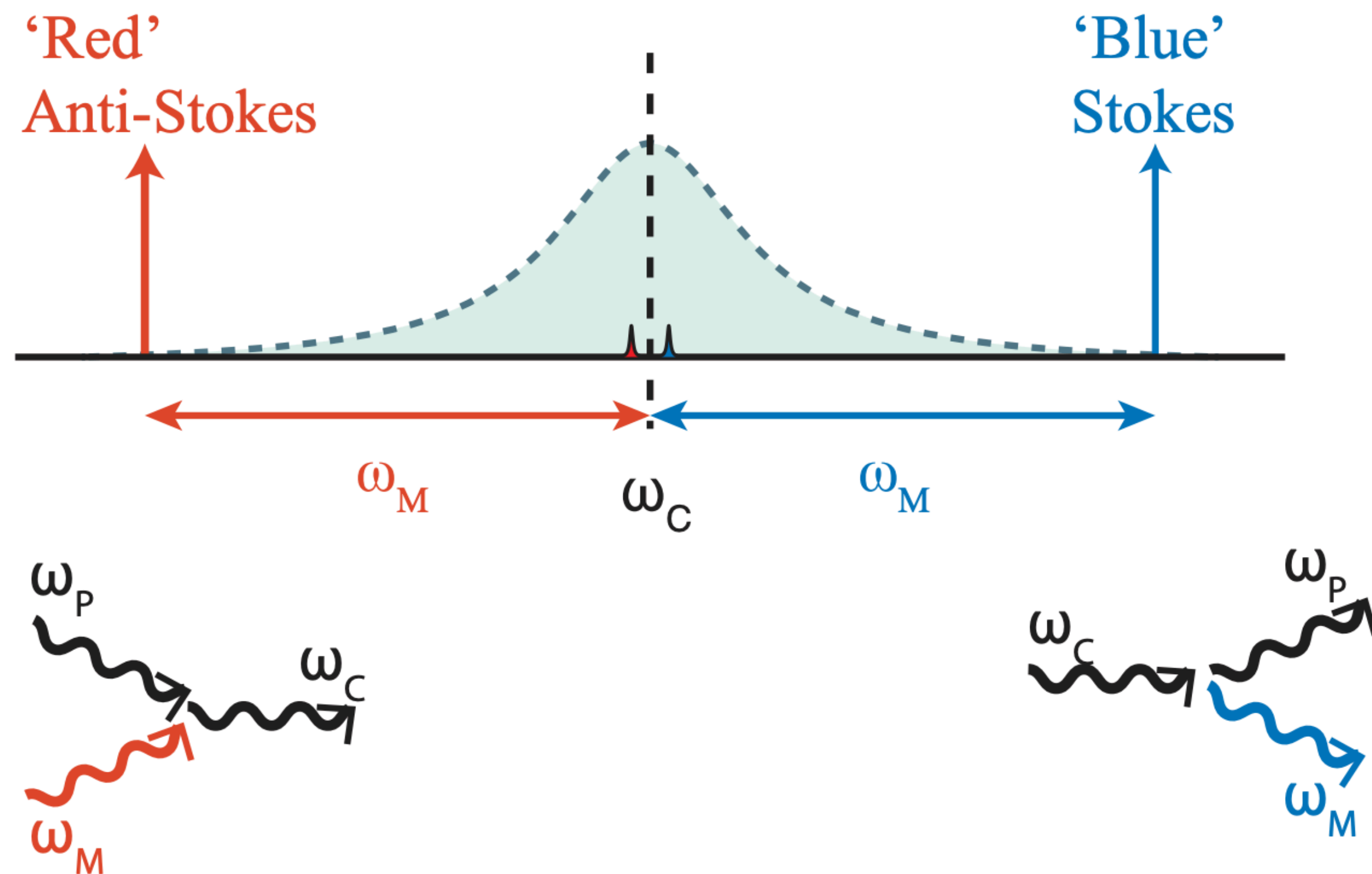
Superfluid Helium Resonator



Goals: $T = 10 \text{ mK}$, $Q = 10^9$, $R = 10 \text{ cm}$, $L = 50 \text{ cm}$

Challenges: isotopic purification, cooling, seismic isolation, clamping loss

Optomechanical Readout



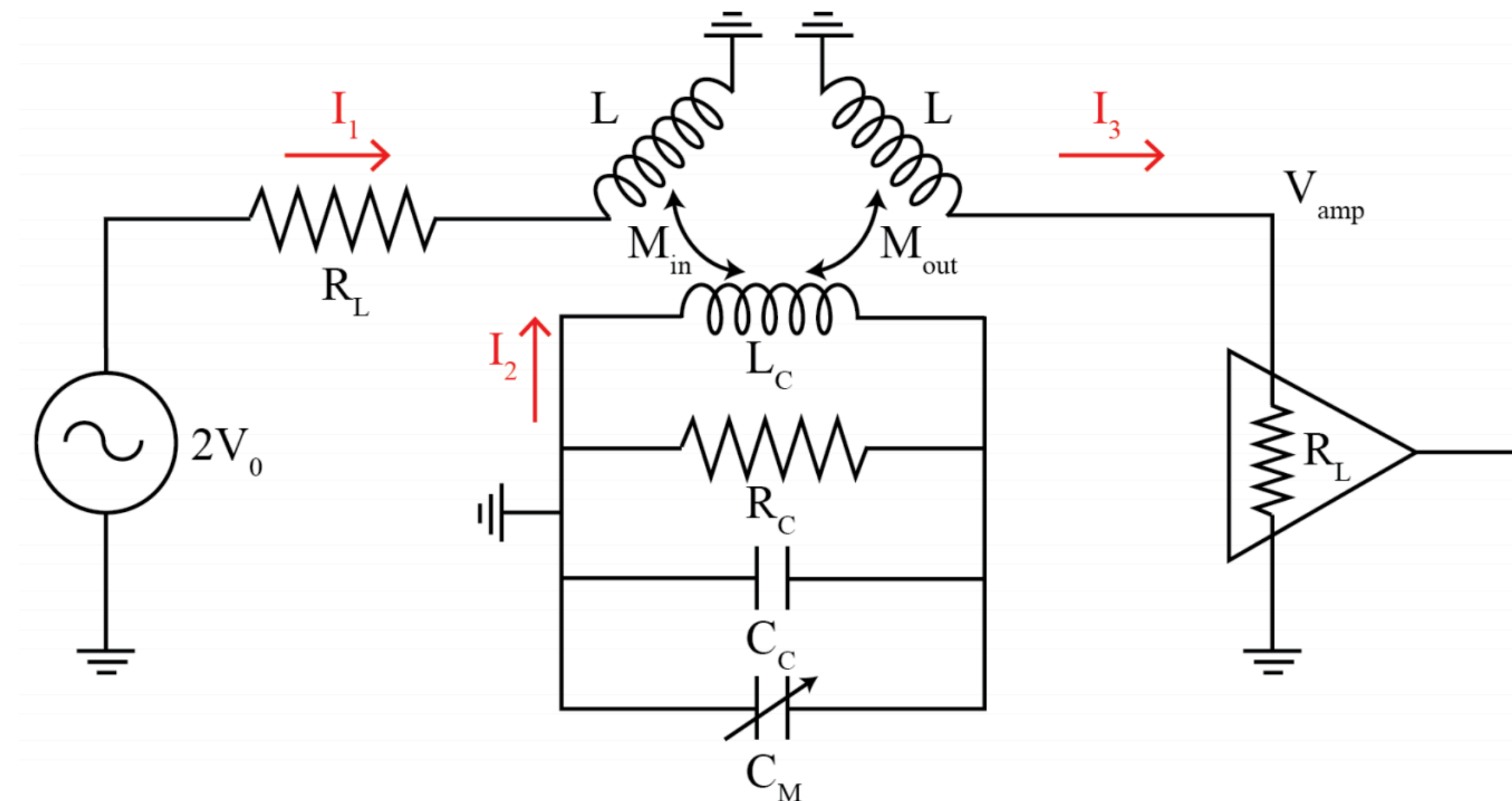
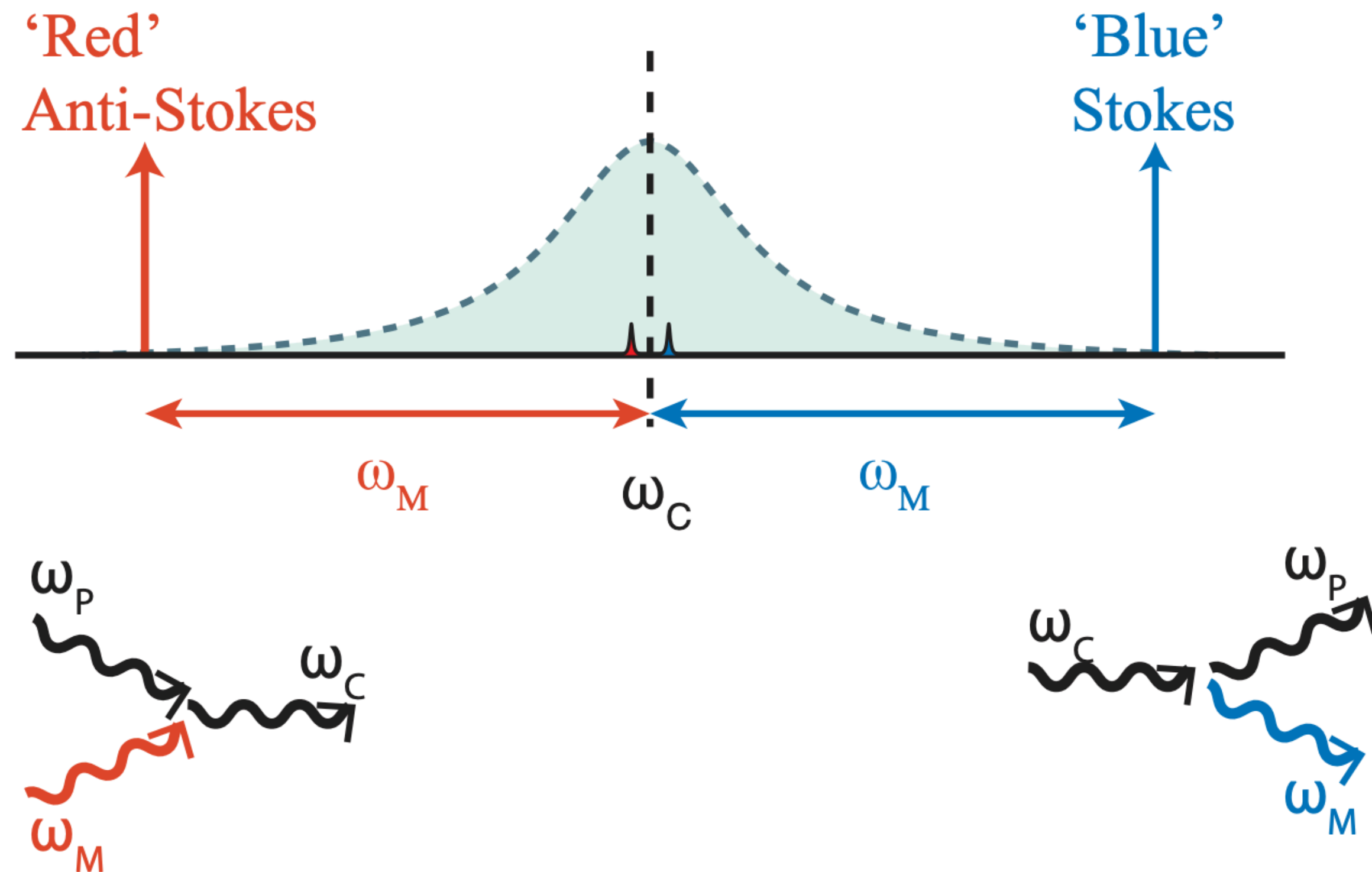
Drive superconducting cavity at red sideband; phonons upconvert photons to resonance

Possible because of optomechanical coupling:

$$g = \frac{\partial \omega_c}{\partial q} \Delta q_{zp}$$

Could also broaden or cool acoustic mode by backaction

Optomechanical Readout



Challenges: cavity losses, oscillator phase noise, amplifier noise, scanning

Thermal noise limited readout not yet demonstrated!

Questions?

